HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My future holds only more pain. I will never feel safe or whole again."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My future holds only more pain. I will never feel safe or whole again." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I actually know about next year, and what am I guessing?
- ☐ Has any day been even slightly different from the worst day?
- ☐ Would I tell a friend their whole future is only pain?
- ☐ What is one small plan that does not require me to feel whole first?
- ☐ What does "mercies new every morning" allow me to expect besides a perfect life?
- ☐ Who can help me look at the future without being flooded?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My future is not only more pain. God is with me, His mercy is new, and wholeness can grow even while I still hurt.
- ☐ I do not know the whole future, and pain does not get to write it.
- ☐ God's mercy is new this morning.
- ☐ I can hurt today and still not be doomed to only hurt.
- ☐ Nothing in the future can separate me from God's love.
- ☐ I can take one day, with a counselor's help, without settling every year.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Lamentations 3:22–23
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"
- ☐ Psalm 30:5
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When the future felt like only pain: Each day, write down one moment when hope felt like a trick. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Lamentations 3:22–23 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His mercies are new this morning. Today is not the whole future.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] One small plan. Schedule one ordinary good thing this week. You do not have to feel whole to keep it.
- [ ] Write "I don't know yet" next to a fear about the future. Leave it unknown instead of tragic.
- [ ] Tell your counselor that the future feels like only pain. Let them help you go slowly.
- [ ] If this includes wanting to die, call or text 988, or tell someone near you today. You do not have to carry a closed future alone.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My future holds only more pain. I will never feel safe or whole again.": _____ %

My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment the future was not only pain
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My future holds only more pain. I will never feel safe or whole again~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have decided the future is only pain. Your mercies are new this morning. Stay with me, open a little room in the days ahead, and give me people who will walk there with me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.